

CULTURE AND MORALITY

Culture – “Cultura” or “cultus” which means care or cultivation.

- Implies that every human being is a potential member of his own social group.

Anthropologist Edward B. Taylor, “Culture is that complex whole which includes knowledge, belief, law, art, moral, customs, and other capabilities and habits acquired as a member of society”.

In Tylor’s view, culture includes all aspects of human activity, from the fine arts to popular entertainment, from everyday behavior to the development of sophisticated technology. It contains the plans, rules, techniques, designs, and policies, for living.

On the other hand, sociologists defined culture as the entire way of followed by people, and everything learned and shared by people in society. (Hunt, et.al, 1994). According to Landis (1992), culture is a complex set of learned and shared beliefs, customs, skills, habits, traditions, and knowledge common to members of society.

THE INFLUENCE OF CULTURE IN MORAL DEVELOPMENT

Culture has been with us since the dawn of human existence. Culture is a social environment in which a person is born and wherein he or she lives together with other persons. Hence, culture has a great impact in the development of human person in varied ways; may it be in physical knowledge, thought, relationship, religious or moral development.

Moreover, culture is a person’s social heritage that has been passed from one generation to the next basically through the relationship that binds the society together. It teaches and conditions members on how to relate and live with the other members of the society and even to people outside of their own culture.

Culture, indeed, provides norms, customs, laws, and moral demands that are to be followed. So to speak, in general, in a culture there is consistency and systematic patterns of behavior. (Palispis, 2007).

Culture influences the moral development of the people. The points below are the following:

1. *Culture is always social and communal by which the relationship of the people towards one another and their experience as a people are the culture’s meadow.*
 2. *The culture defines the normative principles and behavior of the society.*
 3. *Culture, as best exemplified in the experience of the people, development restrictions and sets boundaries and limitations as they live and relate with one another.*
 4. *As culture helps in generating the character and identity of its people, it also includes their moral character.*
- Laws and rules and standards of attitudes and behaviors are set and promulgated by the community to promote that relationship that binds them together as a people.
 - It defines which particular principle and behavior that should be kept that would serve the best interest of the community.
 - These restrictions and boundaries serve as protection among themselves. these would create an atmosphere of promoting the welfare of the community. Culture here draws this consciousness into the moral development of its members.
 - Culture conditions the mind – the way people think and the way people perceive the world and their relationship with one another. Henceforth, a culture which characteristic is aggressive tends to be aggressive in terms of its relationship with one another or with other culture.
 - *In many cultures, men are always* regarded as the leaders who oversee the order of the community and give guidance, which is true in patriarchal societies. Through their roles and responsibilities in the community within the given culture, may it be patriarchal, matriarchal, or whatever; people submit themselves to their authorities.